Pit & Fissure Sealants – Kids Dentistry / Pedodontics

URL: `/dental-care/kids-dentistry/pit-fissure-sealants`

Protecting the Grooves of Growing Teeth

The chewing surfaces of molars contain tiny grooves and pits where food particles and plaque can collect. These narrow areas can be difficult to clean thoroughly, especially for children who are still developing their brushing skills.

Pit and fissure sealants are thin protective coatings applied to the grooves of back teeth to help prevent tooth decay. They create a barrier that makes these surfaces easier to keep clean and less vulnerable to cavities.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, pit and fissure sealants may be recommended as part of a child's preventive dental care plan, depending on the condition of the teeth and the child's risk of developing cavities.

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How Do Pit and Fissure Sealants Work?

Covering Deep Grooves

Sealants flow into the small pits and fissures on molars, covering areas where plaque and food particles can accumulate.

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Creating a Protective Barrier

Once applied and set, the sealant helps prevent food debris and bacteria from settling into the protected grooves.

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Reducing Cavity Risk

Sealants help protect vulnerable chewing surfaces, particularly when combined with fluoride toothpaste, good brushing habits, and regular check-ups.

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Which Children May Benefit?

Pit and fissure sealants are commonly considered for children when their permanent molars erupt. They may also be suitable for selected baby teeth or other teeth with deep grooves, depending on the child's cavity risk.

A dentist may recommend sealants for children who:

- Have newly erupted permanent molars.

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- Have deep pits and fissures that are difficult to clean.

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- Have experienced cavities in other teeth.

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- Need additional protection for vulnerable chewing surfaces.

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The dentist will check the tooth first. If decay is already present, a sealant alone may not be enough; treatment depends on the extent of the damage.

What Happens During Sealant Application?

Pit and fissure sealant treatment is usually quick and does not require drilling when the tooth is suitable for preventive sealing.

1. Cleaning the tooth: The dentist cleans the chewing surface to remove plaque and debris.

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2. Preparing the enamel: A conditioning solution is applied according to the sealant system.

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3. Applying the sealant: The material is placed into the pits and fissures.

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4. Setting the material: Depending on the product, a curing light may be used to harden the sealant.

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5. Checking the bite: The dentist checks the coating and makes adjustments if necessary.

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The procedure is generally painless and does not usually require injections.

How Long Do Sealants Last?

Sealants can protect teeth for several years, but they may wear down or chip over time. During routine dental visits, the dentist checks whether the sealants remain intact and whether any repair or replacement is needed.

Parents can help maintain the protection by encouraging twice-daily brushing with fluoride toothpaste, limiting frequent sugary snacks and drinks, and attending recommended dental check-ups.

Remember, sealants protect the treated grooves; they do not cover every surface of the tooth or eliminate the need for good oral hygiene.

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. At what age can children receive pit and fissure sealants?

They are often considered when the first permanent molars erupt, usually around six years of age, and again when the second permanent molars erupt, commonly around 12 years. Timing depends on tooth eruption and the child's individual needs.

2. Are pit and fissure sealants safe?

Dental sealants are widely used for cavity prevention. The dentist selects an appropriate material and checks that it is suitable for the child's teeth.

3. Does sealant application hurt?

No. The procedure is generally painless and usually does not require drilling or injections.

4. Can sealants be applied to baby teeth?

Yes, selected baby molars may benefit when they have deep grooves or the child has an increased risk of cavities.

5. Do sealants prevent every cavity?

No. They mainly protect the pits and fissures on the treated chewing surfaces. Cavities can still develop elsewhere, so regular brushing and dental check-ups remain important.

6. Can a tooth with a cavity receive a sealant?

It depends on the condition and extent of the decay. A tooth with established decay may need restorative treatment rather than a preventive sealant alone.

7. How often should sealants be checked?

They should be reviewed during routine dental visits. If a sealant becomes damaged or partly detached, the dentist can decide whether it needs repair or replacement.

Give Growing Teeth an Extra Layer of Protection

Pit and fissure sealants can be a useful preventive option for children whose molars are vulnerable to decay. At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, recommendations are to each child's dental development and oral health needs.

CTA: Book a children's dental check-up to find out whether pit and fissure sealants are suitable for your child.

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Please dont use any qualifications like bds mds…just add name, dental surgeon or prosthodontist like that in cta section

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- SEO title: Pit & Fissure Sealants for Kids | Jerush Dental Care
- Meta description: Discover how pit and fissure sealants help protect children's molars from cavities. Learn about application, benefits, aftercare, and preventive dental care at Jerush.
- Primary keyword: Pit and fissure sealants
- Related keywords: Dental sealants for children, molar cavity prevention, fissure sealant treatment, preventive pediatric dentistry, kids dental care
- Image alt text: Dentist applying a protective pit and fissure sealant to a child's molar to help prevent tooth decay.